FIRST DEGREE MENTORING

PREPARE	• Explain the timing, format and general structure (without giving away ritual detail) • Ensure they know the etiqueet and dress code for the ceremony (punctuality, mobile phone off, cash etc) • Ensure they know they will be expected to speak at Festive Board. • Practical tips, everyone has done this, arrive early, relax, you will be guided at every step.
GUIDE	• Introduce to the Tyler, IG and JD. • The purpose of initiation being the symoblic beginning of their masonic journey. • Explain masonic values of: integrity, friendship, respect and service. • Expectations: attendance, contribution, charity and festive boards. • Detail the social side, inportance of friendship and the FHLBC and signpost to Solomon for further study • Encourage visiting another lodges initiation
SUPPORT	• Explain the masonic journey after the first degree. • Questions are encouraged, mentors and brethren available after the ceremony. • Introduce to the lodge and personal mentor. And what a mentor does. • Reassure that the ceremony is symbolic, safe and conducted with dignity and respect. • Identfy questions leading to second. • Explain what Lodge of Instruction is.
ENLIGHTEN	• Moral themes of: Faith, Hope, Charity, Temperance, Fortitude, Prudence and Justice. • Encourage them afterwards to consider how lessons of the First Degree apply personally. • Emphasise the wider role of Freemasonry in supporting communities. • Explain that there are three degrees, each building on the last, with opportunities for personal growth. • DAWG administered by Provincial Mentoring Team.

HERTFORDSHIRE FREEMASONS

MENTORING

Welcome and Congratulations
Congratulations on your appointment as Lodge Mentor. An important and rewarding role within Hertfordshire Freemasonry.

Your purpose is to ensure that every Brother, from a new candidate to a long-standing member, feels prepared, supported, guided and enlightened in their Masonic journey. Mentoring helps each member find their place in the Lodge, understand Freemasonry more deeply, and enjoy everything the Craft offers.

Your Core Responsibilities
As Lodge Mentor, you will:

- Coordinate and oversee all mentoring within your Lodge.
- Ensure a Personal Mentor is appointed for every candidate, and where possible, for joining or returning members.
- Support Personal Mentors with clear guidance and regular communication.
- Act as the link between your Lodge and the Provincial Mentoring Team.
- Promote mentoring as part of the Lodge culture, something every Brother benefits from.
- You don't need to act as a Personal Mentor yourself unless appropriate, but you ensure the mentoring system works smoothly and effectively.

The Four Principles of Mentoring

Prepare
Set every new member up for success:

- Explain expectations, time commitment, and Lodge culture.
- Share insights on etiquette, dress code, and punctuality.
- Outline meeting structure and key roles.
- Introduce the wearing and meaning of regalia.
- Provide a warm, informed welcome — ensuring there are no surprises.

Guide
Help each member find their direction:

- Signpost to the Provincial website and learning resources.
- Assist with learning techniques and personal development.
- Encourage visiting other Lodges and expanding connections.
- Introduce members to the Freemasons Hall Learning & Business Centre (FHLBC).
- Promote lifelong learning and active engagement within the Province.

Support
Be the steady presence behind every Brother's progress:

- Maintain regular contact and build genuine rapport.
- Offer reassurance — mistakes are part of learning.
- Encourage a healthy work/life/Masonic balance.
- Check in regularly, listen actively, and celebrate progress.
- Foster confidence, wellbeing, and belonging within the Lodge.

Enlighten
Inspire curiosity, confidence, and pride in Freemasonry:

- Encourage participation in ceremonies, such as delivering a Charge.
- Share insights into the history, symbolism, and values of the Craft.
- Explore members' aspirations and progression opportunities.
- Promote attendance at Provincial meetings and charitable initiatives.
- Reinforce the importance of community, personal growth, and living Masonic values every day.

HERTFORDSHIRE FREEMASONS